

Advent Wreath Reading

Week Three: The Candle of Joy

READER ONE:

Today is the third Sunday in Advent. Two weeks ago, we began lighting the Advent wreath to prepare the way for the approaching celebration of the birth of our Lord, Jesus Christ. We lit the first two candles [light first and second candles] last week that represented the Hope and Peace that are ours as a result of Christ's coming.

READER TWO:

Advent is not only about waiting. It is about discovering what God is doing while we wait. The prophet Isaiah announces good news to the poor, freedom to the captives, comfort to those who mourn, and restoration to what has been broken. God is preparing something new. God is bringing beauty from ashes and joy where there has been sorrow.

READER ONE:

Today we light the third candle, the candle of **Joy**. (Light the third candle) The light grows brighter. And as it does, our joy grows deeper because we know that God is faithful to fulfill his promises. Come, Lord Jesus. Fill us with your joy and make us ready for your good news. Help us to prepare the way for joy.